

DAY 2 · PREPARATION LAYER

Power Query & Dataflows — The Preparation Layer

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- AI tools can spot data quality issues but they don't fix structural problems. The real cleanup still happens in Power Query.
- Power Query in Excel cleans the file on your laptop. Dataflows clean the data source in the cloud — for everybody, on a schedule.
- Use Copilot to refactor your M code (it's good at that) — but trust your own eyes for the structural changes like unpivoting.
- Cleaned tables landing in Dataverse become the trusted source every other tool downstream — Excel, Power BI, Power Automate, Copilot Studio — can share.

TOOLS YOU TOUCHED

Power Query · Power Query Online · Dataflows · Dataverse · Copilot in Excel

DEMO FILES

quarterly_claims.xlsx
quarterly_claims_solution.xlsx
claims-data-pq-pre-copilot.txt

TRY THIS ON MONDAY

Find one Excel file where someone on your team manually cleans the same columns every week. Build a Power Query for it. Then lift it into a Dataflow so it runs without anyone touching it.

